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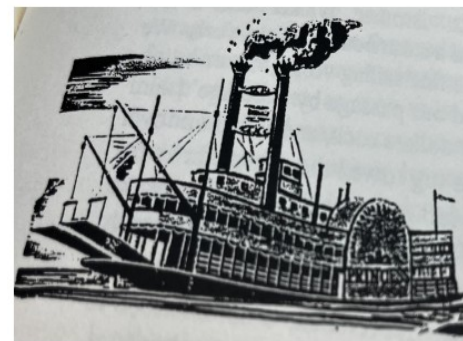
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HENRY LUNT

October 1856 in England

“Brother Weigeland, a member of the L.D.S. Church from Norway and an artist volunteered to paint my portrait in oil colors and kindly presented it to me. It was exhibited in a picture shop for some time and was said to be worth ten pounds.”



CHAPTER XIII

THE CALL TO ENGLAND

Elder Lunt left Salt Lake City for St. Louis on July 8, 1854, accompanied by Erastus Snow, Orson Spencer and others. Snow wrote the following entry in his journal:

August 6: The journey thus far has been prosperous and pleasant. No Indians have bothered us, but we have fought some fierce battles with mosquitoes which have been so annoying since we struck the Platte bottoms that both ourselves and animals have been well nigh devoured.

While crossing the plains Henry Lunt turned thirty years old on July 20, 1854. He kept a journal from the time he left home until he returned home from his mission to England. He wrote the following about the trip:

In August, 1854, I went to Pittsburgh and from there to Philadelphia where I met Brother Walker, another missionary, and we visited the Saints. Brother Winters was very kind to me and gave me five dollars and a fine pair of boots. He got up a farewell party

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and invited a number of saints to a sumptuous supper.

September 22: Brother Walker and I left Philadelphia on board a steamboat for New York. We decided to sail on the fine sailing vessel, *Constitution*, to Liverpool and paid our passage by 'steerage' [third class passage], eight dollars each, and found our own provisions. A steam tug towed the ship as far as the floating lights, then left us to wind our way over the Atlantic by wind and sail. No sooner had the steamer left us when the wind began to blow a brisk breeze, and the noble vessel began to rock. I commenced to be seasick and continued so for the first week.

We arrived in Liverpool October 15, making a speedy and successful voyage from New York to Liverpool in eighteen days. A man who was supposed to have stowed away on the ship at New York was found dead in the hold, and some cotton bales had covered him as the cargo had moved.

After they arrived in Liverpool, a tender took the passengers and luggage from the ship to the Custom House. They walked to the office and were warmly received by Brother Franklin D. Richards and several others. An account told by Henry's daughter, Henrietta, indicated that when he left Salt Lake City, "Henry wore his best which was a broadcloth coat, moccasins, and a pair of pants made from one of Aunt Ellen's, his wife's, blue serge skirts." Brother Richards loaned Henry some money to buy new clothing, apparently observing his homemade clothing. Henry then went to Cheshire and visited his mother who was staying with Mr. and Mrs. Davenport, a cousin and his wife. Davenport was a wealthy and independent gentleman who lived at the Oaklands, a most magnificent place. Henry wrote about the visit:

Mother was delighted to see me again. After spending a few days with her, I went to Birmingham to see my brother, Richard, who was a merchant doing

a large and prosperous business. When I first left Birmingham in 1850, he predicted that I would return in rags and tatters like the prodigal son, but in this he found himself very much mistaken. When I entered his place of business, as soon as he saw me, he took me by the hand and was so overcome by emotion that he could not speak; however, he soon sent the porter for a cab and accompanied me to his fine residence, some three miles distance, and he and his wife and children were exceedingly glad to see me and they treated me very kind. The next morning I accompanied my brother in an omnibus to his mercantile establishment in town. From my appearance, being so well dressed and having a handsome trunk, which Brother Walters of Philadelphia kindly made me a present of, and wearing a neat little finger ring that was given to me in Saint Louis, I think my brother had an idea that I had been to the gold mines in California and had become rich and had seen the error of my ways in joining the Mormons and had come back to stay.

Just as we were about to enter his store, my brother said to me, 'Well, Henry, what are you going to do now you have come back?' I said, 'I have returned as a missionary Elder of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints to preach the Gospel without purse or script.' 'Why,' said he, 'have you got no money?' I said, 'I have a few shillings in my pocket, that's all.' He then went into the counting house and opened the safe and took a new five pound Bank of England note and ten new half sovereigns and put into my hand. I thanked him and put them in my pocket. I had no sooner done so when a very different spirit took possessions of him, and he made use of very bad language about the Mormons. I wished him good morning and thought I would call again when he would feel to be himself again. I went to the post

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office and got a money order for six pounds and sent it to Brother Franklin D. Richards at Liverpool to pay him back the money he loaned me for my clothes, feeling very thankful to our Heavenly Father for opening up my way so soon and unexpectedly.

I spent about a month in visiting relatives in Cheshire, Staffordshire, and Birmingham and bore a faithful testimony to them of the truth of the work of God. My dear mother gave me a sovereign; my sister, Jemima, gave me five shillings; and my brother, Richard, gave me another sovereign--also, Mr. George Peter Hale gave me a sovereign. While in Birmingham I called to see my brother, John, who was living there at that time, and while there my old sweetheart, Martha Bristol, called to see her sister, John's wife. Martha had married a merchant by the name of Husband. While we were both glad to see each other, I very much regretted to see that she felt very unhappy. She invited me to go and see her, but I did not think it was wise for me to do so. During a subsequent visit at my brother John's, his wife told me that her sister, Martha, had fretted and cried considerably since she saw me, and Martha's husband told her that she had better go back with her old Mormon sweetheart and he would give her 500 pounds to go with me. I never saw her but that one time during my whole mission in England.

Henry received an appointment to labor in the South Conference under the Presidency of Pastor Chauncy G. Webb. He left Bristol November 22, 1854, and went to the beautiful little town of Taunton, the County Seat of Somerset, which had a population of 15,000. The Taunton Branch was raised up by Elder William C. Dunbar and had but a few members of the Church scattered through a large district of country. The clergymen and sectarian ministers in the town published and circulated two pamphlets against the Latter-day Saints. They also

held a meeting and wanted Henry to leave; but the Minister of the Church of England would have nothing to do with it, so they did not pursue their plans. Henry baptized eight new members into the church during the month that he was assigned to this district.

Franklin D. Richards was the President of the English Mission during this time and had also been one of the General Agents and Managers as well as the Secretary of the Desert Iron Company which established the Iron Works in Cedar City, Utah in America. He and Henry spent time discussing the problems and successes of the iron operation since Henry had been the Clerk and one of the main supporters of the operation. They published a seven-page article about the iron industry in Iron County in *The Latter-Day Saints Millennial Star*, a publication which was circulated in England. This article was published January 6, 1855, while Henry was in the South Conference and could meet often with President Richards. The report was written to inform the stock-holders of the three-year history of the work accomplished at Coal Creek. It contained an update from Isaac C. Haight, Manager of the Iron Works, written September 4, 1854, after Henry had left Cedar City. Haight described the new blast furnace in Cedar City as being twenty-one feet square, built at a cost of \$3,782.42. They had enlarged the water wheel four feet and made circular cylinders three and one-half feet in diameter which will give a blast of two and one-half pounds to the square inch. They were also building six coke ovens and intended to add more.

Part of the incentive for this publication about the iron in Utah was detailed by Haight in the following letter:

The furnace is said to be as good a furnace as they ever saw in England, or any other county. We hope the brethren in England and Wales will come forward to our assistance and take shares, and send an engine and goods to help us.

President Richards included a report from the architect of the furnace, Elias Morris, and stressed the urgency of manufacturing iron in the "new world." He wrote:

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We feel to urge upon all who desire to build up Zion, and have capital in their hands, to appropriate a portion to strengthen the operations of the Iron Company. There is ample room for profitable investment of capital. Iron can be made in Utah, for it has been done.

The publication was concluded with a quote from Brigham Young, as follows:

We shall never give up what we wish to perform. The Lord guiding and directing us, we shall continue our operations until we manufacture everything we wish to eat, drink and wear in the midst of these mountains so that we shall not be under the necessity of going to any other place in the whole earth to get anything we wish to consume.

Haight noted in his journal in April 1855 that the furnace was working well and had turned out as high as 1700 pounds of good iron in four hours.

About this time Henry, still working hard to convert the people of England to the church, received an appointment from President Richards to preside over the entire South Conference with headquarters in Bristol. Henry wrote the following about this assignment:

I found most of the Saints in Bristol very poor and the Conference very much in debt to the Liverpool office for books. On making a close investigation through the conference, I could not find a single person who could emigrate even as far as to the United States, to say nothing of going through to Utah. Brother Atwood and I walked to the city of Bath and then on to visit the branches in Devonshire. I walked eighty miles during the past week. There

was a good sized branch of the Church in South Molton and, as there were some existing difficulties, my visit was much needed and much good was done. When I had walked to Barnstable, twelve miles from South Moulton, I took off my shoes and found my socks quite wet with blood through walking so much. I traveled on foot for several hundred miles during the months following, visiting many small branches and preaching the Gospel when an opportunity offered, some of the time in company with Pastor Millen Atwood and at other times with some of the traveling Elders.

I left Leeds on January 26, 1855, for the town of Hull in company with Brother W. G. Young. While there I met with quite a number of people who were well acquainted with my dear brother, Thomas, who was the youngest child in the family and had ran a business in Hull for some few years. In looking over the records of the Hull Branch, I found my brother's name recorded as being baptized by Elder Hugh Findley on April 27, 1851, and confirmed by him on the same day.

Henry went to see the man, Mr. Cook, who had bought his brother's business for twelve hundred pounds, which was about six thousand dollars. He informed Henry that Thomas had left for Australia with the intention of eventually going to America to make his home in Utah. Henry wrote the following about Thomas's trip and the subsequent problems that took place:

He [Thomas] sailed from Liverpool the 19th of January, 1854, on the new *Iron Clipper* sailing vessel. The ship was wrecked in the Irish Channel, about thirteen miles from Dublin, two days later and 400 to 600 souls perished. My brother had his wife and eight-year-old son, David, and a servant girl along. I was

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informed by my brother, Richard, that a short time before the dreadful calamity that my brother, Thomas, came up out of the saloon cabin and addressed a gentleman by the name of Cutts as follows: 'Mr. Cutts, this ship will be wrecked.' At the same time, taking some insurance papers from his side coat pocket, he said, 'You will be saved, but I will be drowned, and I want you to give these papers to my brother, Richard, of Birmingham.' Mr. Cutts did so, showing that my poor brother's prediction had its literal fulfillment. A Sister Greensides of Hull gave me a Book of Mormon which belonged to Thomas, which I very much prize.

Mr. Cook, the owner of Thomas's business, spoke well of him. He said that everyone liked him and that he was an honorable and upright young man. Thomas had made it known that he did not feel altogether well satisfied about going on this trip, and the night before he left he actually wept aloud. Mr. Cook said that when news of the ship wreck reached them the store was crowded with people making inquiries. Henry noted that he and Thomas were more attached to each other than any of the others in the family and that Thomas's wife was bitterly opposed to Mormonism.

While Henry was in Bristol a special conference was held on May 20, 1855, back home in Cedar City, under the direction of President Brigham Young. Wilford Woodruff, who was present, wrote the following about what took place:

It was moved by President Young that Isaac Haight be appointed the President of this [new Cedar] Stake of Zion which embraces Cedar City, Harmony and Johnson's Fort. As the twelve High Counselors of this Stake of Zion, Jonathan Pugmire Sr., Robert Wiley, Samuel White, Richard Harrison, Perry Liston, Ira Allen, Samuel Lee, Laban Morrel, Rufus C. Allen, Thomas D. Brown, Joshua T. Willis and Charles

Hopkins were chosen and ordained. Counselors to President Haight in the Stake were Jonathan Pugmire and John Higbee.

President Young made the following remarks at this conference, which were written in the Cedar Records:

The spirit of the people is rather dull. Making iron is as holy a calling as to go preaching the Gospel to the nations of the earth.....I don't want to raise a particle, if the damned infernal gentiles are coming here to eat it up. I would rather live on roots and the mountain elk, deer and cattle than see their infernal--here again, for they are the very scum of Hell and would cut the throat of every man and woman and child here if they had the power.

President Young, once again, advised the people of Cedar Fort to move the townsite because the fort was located on the flood plain where it was obvious that the waters from Coal Creek would do, and had done, excessive damage. There were great boulders and driftwood that had accumulated along the stream bed which the settlers would have to remove. Young advised the settlers to move one mile nearer to the mouth of the canyon. That afternoon he planted his cane (on the corner of the present 200 North and 200 East) and said, "This will be your townsite. Build south and west of here--no farther north." However, several years elapsed before the old site was completely vacated. Some residents even chose to leave the settlement rather than move again.

When the Cedar Stake was organized John C. L. Smith had been the President of the Iron County Stake and remained in the position of President of the Parowan Stake. Henry Lunt had been a counselor to Smith before he left for England. Unfortunately, before Henry returned home President Smith died of heart disease at the age of 33 in Dec 1855, and William H. Dame was sustained as Stake President on January 20, 1856.

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The summer after Henry left for England to fulfill an L.D.S. Mission in that country the settlers were forced to contend with great challenges. Because of the hot, dry weather in 1855, hordes of grasshoppers hatched and migrated to the fields in Cedar Valley. The people fought the invaders to the point of exhaustion, but all to no avail. The hoppers went through the fields and gardens leaving the valley as bare as if it had been swept by fire. The following winter and spring of 1856 brought the darkest days that Iron County ever experienced—even the food supplies ran out. The grasshoppers returned in the summer of 1856, and devoured every green thing visible in many parts of Utah. The terrible drought, one of the severest ever known, completed the work of devastation.

The settlers waited anxiously for winter to come. The winter of 1856 was one of the coldest and wettest ever known. Cattle ranges were buried under heavy snows and thousands of animals died of cold and starvation. During the early months of 1856 many of the inhabitants were driven to digging roots in order to survive until harvest time came. Andrew Neff wrote in *The History of Utah* that there was not much run-off in the creeks the spring of 1857. He painted a very grave picture of Cedar City's situation as follows:

Last winter [1856-87] the snow was still deeper [than the year before], and this spring there is still less water in the creeks. Add to this the last three seasons that the crops have been eaten up by grasshoppers and blue worms or filled with smut. The future promises nothing better, but with the continual influx of population they [the residents of southern Utah] must either constantly find new valleys to settle or starvation and removal will be inevitable. They have fiercely battled with obstacles thus far in their strife with nature. A few more seasons such as their last three will effectually starve them out.

Most of the residents renewed their covenants in the Gospel by re-baptism in keeping with the general reformation which took place

throughout the Church. The saints were asked to reform and everyone was required to observe the laws of God more fully. Each person who erred was chastised by his or her Bishop and was required to make restitution for any wrong-doing. There was some apostasy, but most were humbled and tried to improve during these troublesome times of famine and strife. Henry Lunt's wife, Ellen, was secretary for the Female Benevolent Society during Henry's absence, and became privy to much of the information about many of the problems that occurred.

Henry received mail from home only intermittently, but probably was informed by Ellen of the happenings at home. It was difficult for him not to worry about the situation of the settlers. Henry spent approximately a year and a half in the South Conference, and then he left for Newcastle upon Tyne where he was to take charge of the Carlisle and Durham Conferences. He had become well-acquainted with many Saints and they met and expressed their love and devotion for him and were complimentary of his wisdom and kindness. Henry wrote the following in his journal:

On October the 20th, 1856, I attended the Sheffield Conference by invitation of Elder William G. Young, afterwards attended the Nottingham Conference by invitation of Apostle Ezra T. Benson, and then we went to Birmingham where we visited my dear old mother at Mount Pleasant, Staffordshire, and laid our hands upon her head and blessed her, Brother Benson being mouth. On my return to my field of labor, I received the *Millennial Star* [a Church publication] containing a list of releases and appointments, and found the welcome news of my being released to return home the following year. Elder William J. Smith of the 7th Ward, Salt Lake City, was appointed to succeed me. I took him to most of the travelers in the three conferences to introduce him to the Saints.

Brother Dan Weigeland, a member of the Church and an artist from Norway, volunteered to paint my

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portrait in oil colors which he did and kindly presented it to me. It was exhibited in a picture shop window for some time and was said to be worth ten pounds.

Henry was "Pastor" of the Newcastle Upon Tyne, Carlisle and Durham Conferences during 1856, and a great many people were baptized into the Church there. He was instrumental in helping to raise a quantity of money through contributions, and he liquidated a large debt at Liverpool as well as added to the Temple and Emigration Funds. All the tithing money was sent to the President of the European Mission at Liverpool. Henry visited the South Conference and the Birmingham Conference and then went to London in response to an invitation from Apostle Ezra T. Benson who was sick. Henry administered to him which seemed to help greatly.

After spending several weeks in London, Henry traveled to several other cities and visited friends and relatives. One of the places he visited was the Newcastle upon Tyne Conference which included Carlisle, England. Earlier, while he was serving in this area, he conducted and preached in a conference in June, 1856. At the close of the meeting a young woman, Mary Ann Wilson, came up to him and expressed her satisfaction with his sermon and told him that "it appeared that he had been acquainted with all she had been anxious to know for some time and he had answered every inquiry in her mind." She became more interested as she continued to investigate the Gospel, and a deep friendship grew between them. After she was baptized July 27, 1856, by Elder Thomas Adams, her family disowned her. Henry advised her to sell her personal belongings and join the saints going to America which she did, and sailed from Liverpool on March 28, 1857, on board the *George Washington* which had 817 saints on board, bound for Boston. During the last visit to Carlisle Mary Ann Wilson gave Henry a poem which she had written and inscribed to Mrs. Henry Lunt:

A SIMILITUDE

In Ephraim's vale, a floweret bloomed
Surpassing lovely was its hue;

It spread its fragrance all around
The pleasant spot on which it grew
Yet, so lovely and so sweet,
'Twas full of grace and modesty,
And strove to hide its loveliness
From the rude gaze of passers by.
But there was one of beauteous form,
Of graceful mein and noble birth
Who chanced to see its tiny head,
And not because in gorgeous tints
Of dazzling beauty 'twas arrayed,
But for the unassuming grace
That threw a halo round its head.
But when he saw its tender stem
And thought on storms that might arise
And blight its lovely beauteous bloom,
He gently plucked the dear loved prize
And in his bosom safely placed
This sweet and fragrant flower,
And there it blooms secure from harm
And every blighting power.
This flower an emblem is, of her
Who is the hope, the joy, the life,
Of one of Israel's noblest sons
His dear and fondly cherished wife.
Oh, still may she in beauty bloom
And dwell in peace and sweet content,
And bless with pure devoted love
Her honored husband, Henry Lunt.

Henry stayed in England until April 25, 1857, traveling with Ezra T. Benson to various conferences. He arrived in Liverpool barely in time to board the sailing ship, *Westmoreland*, which had moved out of dock ready to leave when he arrived. Mathias Cowley was appointed to the position of President and Henry and Brother Lillenquist were appointed Counselors over one of the four wards

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which were organized on the ship. There were 539 Scandinavian Saints out of a total of 575 passengers on board. Henry was often invited to eat with Captain Decan in his cabin. The voyage from London to Philadelphia was made in five weeks. They arrived at their destination on Sunday afternoon, the last day of May, and the Captain expressed that he was pleased with the good order and conduct of the L.D.S. passengers. Henry went ashore with several other brethren to see Angus M. Cannon who was presiding over the Church there. The company left on the Baltimore and Ohio railroad on June 2, 1857, fare being \$10.50 for adults. It took a week to reach Iowa City where they met James A. Little and a group of elders at the camping ground. Henry and Brother Cowley left the emigrant train at Rock Island and took an express train to Iowa City to arrive there in time to prepare for the emigrant train. A number of the Saints started out with hand carts the evening of June 12 and camped about three miles away. The next day Henry, Brother Little and several others went out and organized them by appointing Elder James P. Park as Captain of the handcart company which consisted of two groups with 200 persons in each. They appointed a Captain over each group along with a clerk and an interpreter. On June 13, Henry wrote the following account:

On leaving the camp [outside of Iowa City], I stood up in a wagon and swung my hat and gave three cheers for the handcart company and said, 'God bless them,' which was responded to by a tremendous and loud 'amen' by all the company. I had very peculiar feelings in seeing them start, and could scarcely refrain from shedding tears as well as laughing, for it was certainly a very peculiar sight--such a one that I never saw before and truly I felt like asking our Heavenly Father to bless them, as they had a journey of some twelve hundred miles before them, having to wade many rivers and cross the plains which were inhabited only by wild Indians, buffalo, and wild beasts.

Monday, June 15: I left camp in company with Elder James Little per railway for St. Louis for the

purpose of purchasing supplies for to fit out the companies of saints at Florence on the Missouri River near to the old Winter Quarters (The railway went only about fifty miles to Muscatine). We stayed at Muscatine until eleven p.m., when we went on board the U.S. Mail steamboat, *Ben Campbell*, and resumed our journey on the Mississippi River. We passed Nauvoo next morning on the eastern banks of the river and, as I gazed on the remains of the once beautiful temple and the houses which were built by the industry of the saints and now inhabited by wicked gentiles and the temple which was built and dedicated to the Lord now lying in ruins with only one end standing, I reflected on the times that were passed and the persecutions of the saints and, then again, on the future with the satisfaction of knowing that the Lord will avenge the wrongs of His people and the blood of His servants which has been shed by wicked men. As I was deeply meditating over the above named scenes, looking at the famed city from the hurricane deck looking where I was standing as the boat glided down the 'father of waters,' one of the cabin passengers came and stood by my side and commenced talking about Nauvoo and the Mormons. He said that Brigham Young and all the leaders deserved to be killed off, and manifested the same hellish spirit in him as did the demons who persecuted and slew the saints in the days of Joseph. The first opportunity I had, I resorted to a place which was about as high as I could get, being by the pilot house, I took off my hat and offered up a prayer unto Israel's God for this said man and all such enemies to God's people. Stayed four hours at Keokuk and went on board the beautiful steamboat, *Keokuk*, and arrived at St. Louis the next day at eleven a.m. where we met with Elder Horace Eldredge and several brethren.

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Next day, June 18, 1857, twenty-five brethren from Utah arrived in St. Louis on missions to the States, Europe, and Africa. They reported fifty others who had not arrived in St. Louis. The whole of them had crossed the plains with handcars and appeared healthy and strong and in excellent spirits. While in St. Louis I assisted Brother James A. Little in transacting business for the emigration of the saints over the plains. I traveled from St. Louis to Florence, Nebraska Territory on the steamboat, *S. A. Ogden*, which was carrying 59,615 pounds of freight, as well as a number of saints who had steerage passage. The captain gave me a saloon cabin, passage free. The river was rising very fast and the current was so strong that we made but slow progress. I was told that in a distance of twenty miles on the Missouri River we passed no less than 32 sunken steamboats which had run against snags. While we were taking on wood at a woodyard, the steamboat, *Oceana*, came by with 200 U.S. Troops aboard and a quantity of mules and wagons. I was informed that they were bound for Fort Leavenworth, thence to Salt Lake City, and that there were 3000 going there to protect the new governor, Alfred Cummings, and enable him to enforce the law. Much excitement has been raised against the Mormons by the evil and lying reports of Judge Drummond and others of the U.S. officers who have returned from Utah because they were not allowed to practice sin and iniquity.

We arrived at Florence [Omaha] on June 30th, and from the 30th of June until the 12th of July, 1857, I was very busy hauling freight from the steamboat to the warehouse and dealing out provisions to the emigrants and otherwise assisting them. I attended several preaching and counsel meetings.

I started this morning, July 12th, in company with

some fifty other brethren and sisters for Salt Lake Valley. There were nineteen wagons in the company, all ox teams. I had two yokes of cattle and one wagon and three passengers with their luggage and provisions. The passengers were Sister Sinclair (a widow) and her daughter, Jane, and Brother, Richard Newness. Sister Sinclair was a very worthy woman from North Shields whose husband had been a sea captain. She and her daughter had come as far as Florence but, for want of means, could not proceed any further and, as she had been very generous in entertaining the Elders for many years, I felt it to be my duty to assist them by taking them with me. Brother Newness, who gave me forty dollars for his passage and provisions, and I slept on the ground under the wagon all the distance of a thousand miles over the plains, and widow Sinclair and her daughter slept on my feather bed in the wagon. We encountered many heavy thunder storms during the journey and sometimes the water would run under our bed under the wagon. We camped on the Big Pappio Creek the first night from Florence and effected an organization of which I was Chaplain.

July 19: We crossed the river in the afternoon which is a very difficult stream to cross owing to the quicksand. We had to hitch from six to eight yoke of cattle to each wagon and we all got over safe by dark. I waded the river, which is about half a mile wide with very swift current, seven times.

July 31: During the last five days we have seen an immense quantity of Buffaloes--the Platte Valley has been literally black with them. We were compelled to stop our train a number of times for them to get out of the way as we were fearful of our cattle becoming frightened and stampeding. Once a very large bull buffalo was alone behind the main herd of several

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thousand head, which had just crossed the South Fork of the Platte, and he came on a lope going west after the herd and, but for me firing a shot from my revolver at him in the head which turned him close by the hind end of the wagon, he would have bounded between my two yoke of oxen and, being the last wagon that day in the train, providently avoided serious results.

August 7: Camped near to a very large camp of Sioux Indians. The chief and many of his braves visited us in the evening and were very friendly. They sat down on the ground forming a large circle. We gave them some crackers, sugar and tobacco. I explained to them the best I could, through gestures, that we were Mormons and their true friends and, by and by, Indians and Mormons would be one and that they would not be oppressed and driven as they and the Mormons had been. They appeared to understand considerable and much pleased, so much so that the chief put his arms 'round my neck and saluted me with a kiss.

August 9: Drove about seven miles and camped, as the day was very hot. Some Government officers passed on the South Fork of the Platte. A few of our brethren went over to talk to them but could not learn much, only that they were going ahead of their train of supplies that was behind them. About this time, green-headed flies and mosquitoes were very annoying to both man and beast.

August 12: We passed the grave of one of our Danish brethren. The wolves had dug up the body which made it a frightful sight to behold.

August 21: We crossed the Platte opposite Fort Laramie and camped in the evening where we met Brother Samuel W. Richards and Brother Snyder who were on their way to Liverpool as missionaries. There were several other brethren along and we held a very

pleasant meeting.

August 23: We met Brother Parks with four yoke of oxen to render assistance to those who most needed it. We camped near to the station on Horseshoe Creek. There are some half dozen log houses erected here with an excellent corral for the purpose of forming a station on the line between Salt Lake and the Missouri River for the benefit of a carrying company, called the Y X Company, which had been organized in Salt Lake City by President Brigham Young. It would have, evidently, been a most excellent thing if the U.S. Government had let us alone, but, 'Uncle Sam' is sending 4000 troops to Salt Lake with the intention of killing and destroying the Saints of God. President Young, however, was determined that they should not have their own way in that matter. In consequence of this army coming, President Young gave orders to vacate all the stations and burn the houses and corrals. We held a meeting in the evening with Brother Bennett and the brethren who decided to return with us to Salt Lake.

The Company Henry was traveling with met seventy people with twenty-eight horses and ox teams at Deer Creek on August 28. This group traveled on with them. They passed the Devil's Gate station on September 2, and camped along the Sweetwater River. Henry reflected that he "saw some very interesting and romantic scenery while alone in this sequestered and remote part of the earth where the footprints of white man seldom were seen, and nothing had been molested since it rolled out of the hands of the Creator."

The Company met two men on horseback, Brothers Bennett and Holly, who said they had been to Fort Laramie as spies, pretending they were gold diggers returning to California. They had met several hundred government troops and conversed with the officers who said the soldiers were going to Salt Lake to hand Brother Brigham and Heber C. Kimball and others their writs, and they swore and cursed

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and boasted of what great things they would do. Henry wrote, "They will find their boasting is in vain long before they get there."

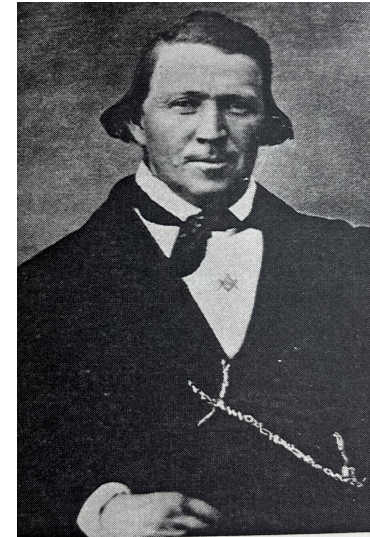
Brigham Young sent several brethren from Salt Lake with thirty-nine yoke of oxen to help the emigration company, and they met at Fort Bridger on September 14. They also met others who had been to see President Young and were escorting Captain Van Vliet of the U.S. Army as far as the government camp on Harn's Fork. Another company, under the leadership of W. G. Young, caught up with Henry's company here, and they all started together for Salt Lake on September 18. They arrived on September 25, 1857, where Henry wrote the following:

I was invited to put up at Ezra Benson's house and supper was immediately prepared, to which myself and Brother Martin did ample justice. Vegetables and peach pie were indeed a great luxury which those only can fully appreciate who have been traveling for several months over the desert plains encountering heat and dust. After supper I accompanied Brother Martin to his mother-in-law's, Sister Moor's, in the 19th Ward, where I met with Sister Mary Ann Wilson, a very worthy and intelligent young lady who came from England from my Pastorate this year. Sister Martin went into the garden and fetched a milk pan full of peaches of the finest kind and set them before me, expressing a desire for me to help myself freely to all I could eat which truly I did, and by no means sparingly. After several hours in chatting together and rejoicing in each other's company, I retired to Sister Benson's to rest on a good feather bed which was a great luxury, especially when contrasting to sleeping on the hard ground under the wagon on the plains for nearly three months.

September 26: I went to report myself to President Young. He bid me welcome home. I had an agreeable interview of about two hours with him. He said,

'Well, Brother Henry, go and rest yourself and get ready to do again.' Notwithstanding the bold step he had taken in repelling the United States Army from entering Salt Lake Valley, which was sent by James Buchanan with malicious intentions towards the Saints based upon false reports by Judge Drummond, I never before saw him look so cheerful and happy. His countenance beamed and looked Heavenly, lit up by the Spirit of God, which church he is presiding over upon the earth and, may he live to see his enemies wasted away like the dew before the morning sun.

The foregoing chapter is from Henry Lunt's Missionary Journal, pages 214 through 225. The journal was obtained from the B.Y.U. Library, Provo, Ut. - copied in 1955.



BRIGHAM YOUNG

President of the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints
While in Salt Lake City, Utah, after arriving from his mission to England, Henry Lunt wrote, "I asked President Young if I could have the privilege of having a young woman sealed to me. He said, 'Come to my office with her in about one hour's time.'"